

# Power Distance

Billy

May 26 , 2026

## Recall Core Concept:

### Power Distance:

In Geert Hofstede's Cultural Dimensions Theory, Power Distance measures the extent to which the less powerful members of organizations and institutions accept and expect that power is distributed unequally.

## High Vs Low Power Distance Societies

### 1. High Power Distance Societies

In cultures with a high Power Distance index (PDI), Inequality is seen as a fundamental, functional baseline of human society. Everyone has their rightful place in a strict hierarchy.

#### Core Traits:

- Centralized Authority
- visible status symbols
- Acceptance of privilege
- Respectful Distance

### 2. Low Power Distance Societies

In cultures with a low Power Distance index, society stresses equal rights, flat structures, and opportunity for all. Inequality is viewed as an artificial, practical inconvenience that should be minimized wherever possible.

#### Core Traits:

- Decentralized Power
- Interdependence
- Minimizing Status
- Open Contradiction

In Cameroonian culture inequality and hierarchy are generally accepted as normal foundational parts of the social fabric. Power is expected to be centralized, and respect for authority whether based on age, titles, wealth, or traditional positioning is deeply ingrained.